prisoners and play a pro-active role in the resolution of the sixty-two-year-old Kashmir problem."[4]

In May 2009, accusations were made that two young Kashmiri women had been raped and murdered by Indian police or soldiers, who were charged with those crimes by the International People's Tribunal on Human Rights and Justice in Indian-administered Kashmir. That tribunal's report was presented to the 10th International Kashmir Peace Conference by Dr. Angana Chatterji. "A will to peace in Kashmir requires an attested commitment to justice, palpably absent in the exchanges undertaken by the Government of India and its attendant institutions with Kashmir civil society," she read. "The . . . structure of impunity connected to militarization, and corresponding human rights abuses, bear witness to the absence of accountability inherent to the dominion of Kashmir by the Indian state."[5] Months of violent protests shut down the town of Shopian, thirty-five miles south of Srinagar, where the girls' dead bodies were found in the usually shallow Rambi River. Autopsies by Kashmiri doctors concluded that the murdered girls had been raped, after which four local police officers were arrested for "suppressing and destroying evidence in the case."[6] Then, on 28 September 2009, a team of New Delhi doctors conducted more elaborate autopsies, including DNA testing by forensic experts from the All India Institute of Medical Science, who studied tissue taken from both corpses, which had been exhumed by India's Central Bureau of Investigation (CBI). The CBI team, which examined the autopsy findings, reported that both girls had died of suffocation caused by drowning. Kashmiri doctors who had performed the first autopsies were then charged with "falsifying evidence . . . to serve an ideological agenda." The four arrested policemen were released. "It is nothing but a bundle of lies," said Shakheel Ahmed Ahangar.[7] His dead wife, Neelofar Jan, had just recently turned twenty-two; her dead sister, Asiya Jan, was only seventeen.

Dr. Fai concluded the Kashmir Peace Conference he chaired by appealing to "the Obama Administration for serious engagement of the United States with both India and Pakistan for a speedy resolution of the festering Kashmir problem."[8] U.S. support will encourage both India and Pakistan to work with Kashmir's leaders in drafting diplomatic agreements to maintain the cease-fire started in 2004, and then progressively to withdraw all their troops from the new international border, the former Line of Control, and all military and paramilitary